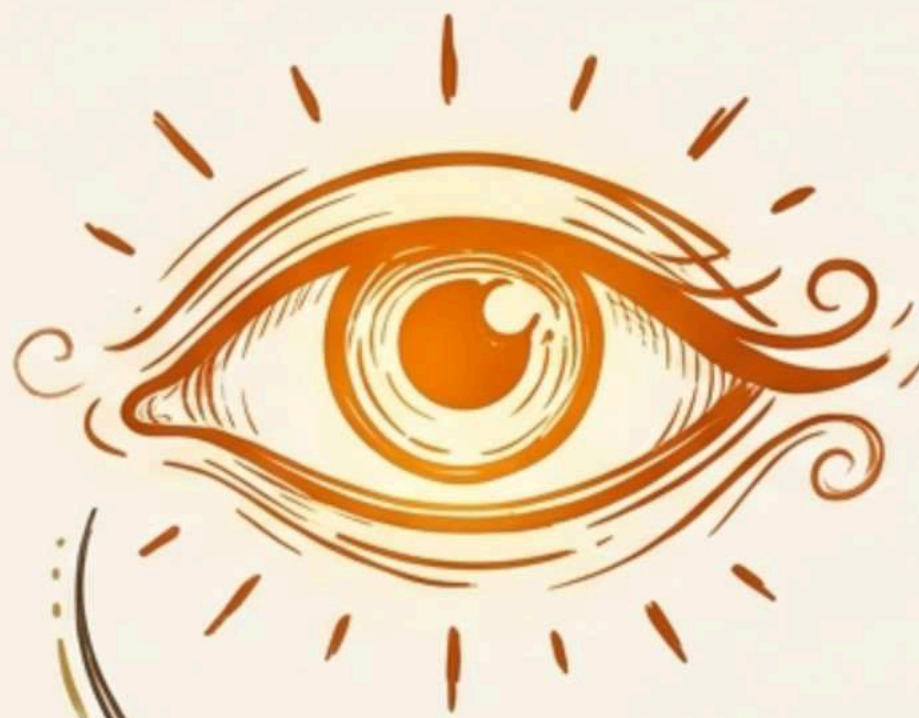




The Seeker's Guide to Shaddarshana

Navigating the Six Major Systems of Indian Philosophy



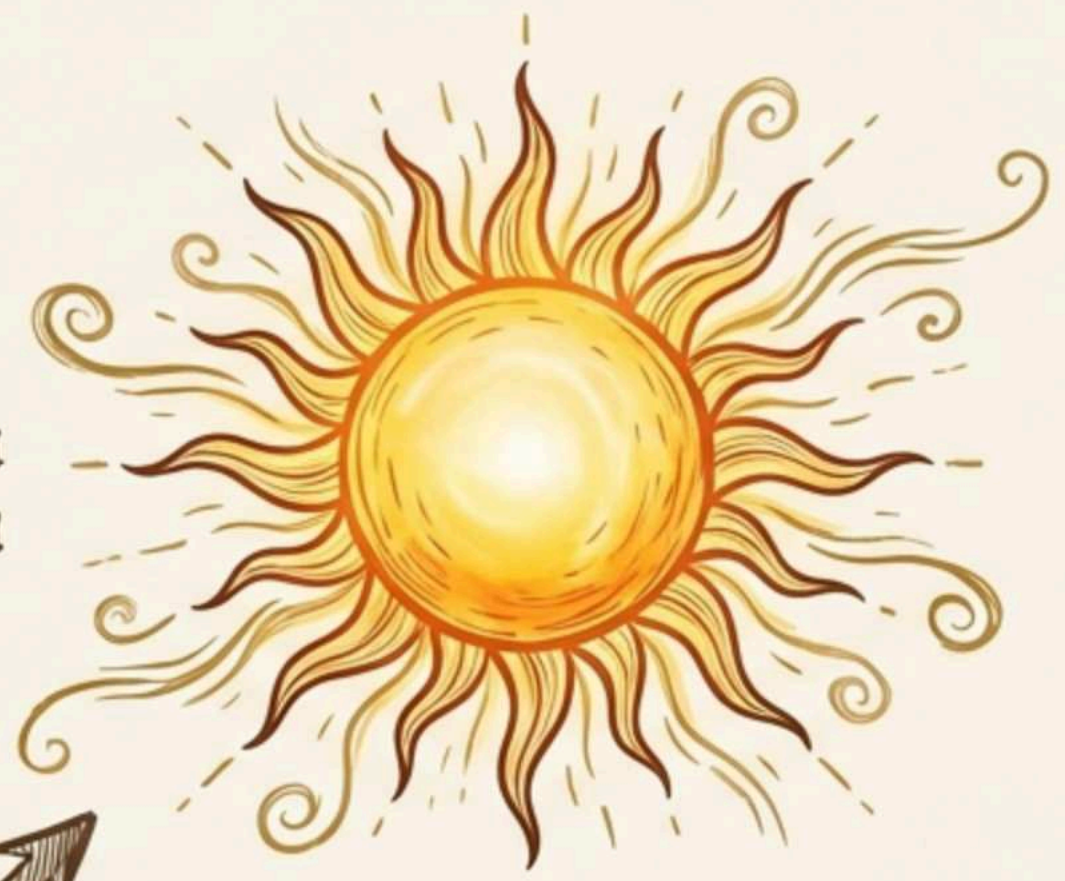
Iksha

(To see)



Anvisha

(Careful seeing,
contemplation, or intuition)



Darshana

(Vision of Truth) — A careful,
serious inquiry into the nature
of the self or the world.



Guided by Anvikshiki:

*The foundational science that sets the standards for logic, law, and interpretation.
All practices in Indian life are determined in the light of Anvikshiki.*

Nāstika

(The Rejection)

They do not accept Vedic authority.

- Lokayata
- Buddhist
- Jain

Āstika

(The Acceptance)

They accept Vedic authority.

- Samkhya-Yoga
- Nyaya-Vaisheshika
- Mimamsa-Vedanta

← The Authority of the Vedas →

Indian
Philosophy

The Nastika Rebellion



Lokayata (Charvaka)

- Core View: Pure materialism. Only direct perception (*pratyaksha*) is true.
- Quote: "Enjoy the taste of pure ghee and the joy of health, even if you have to borrow for it."



Buddhist

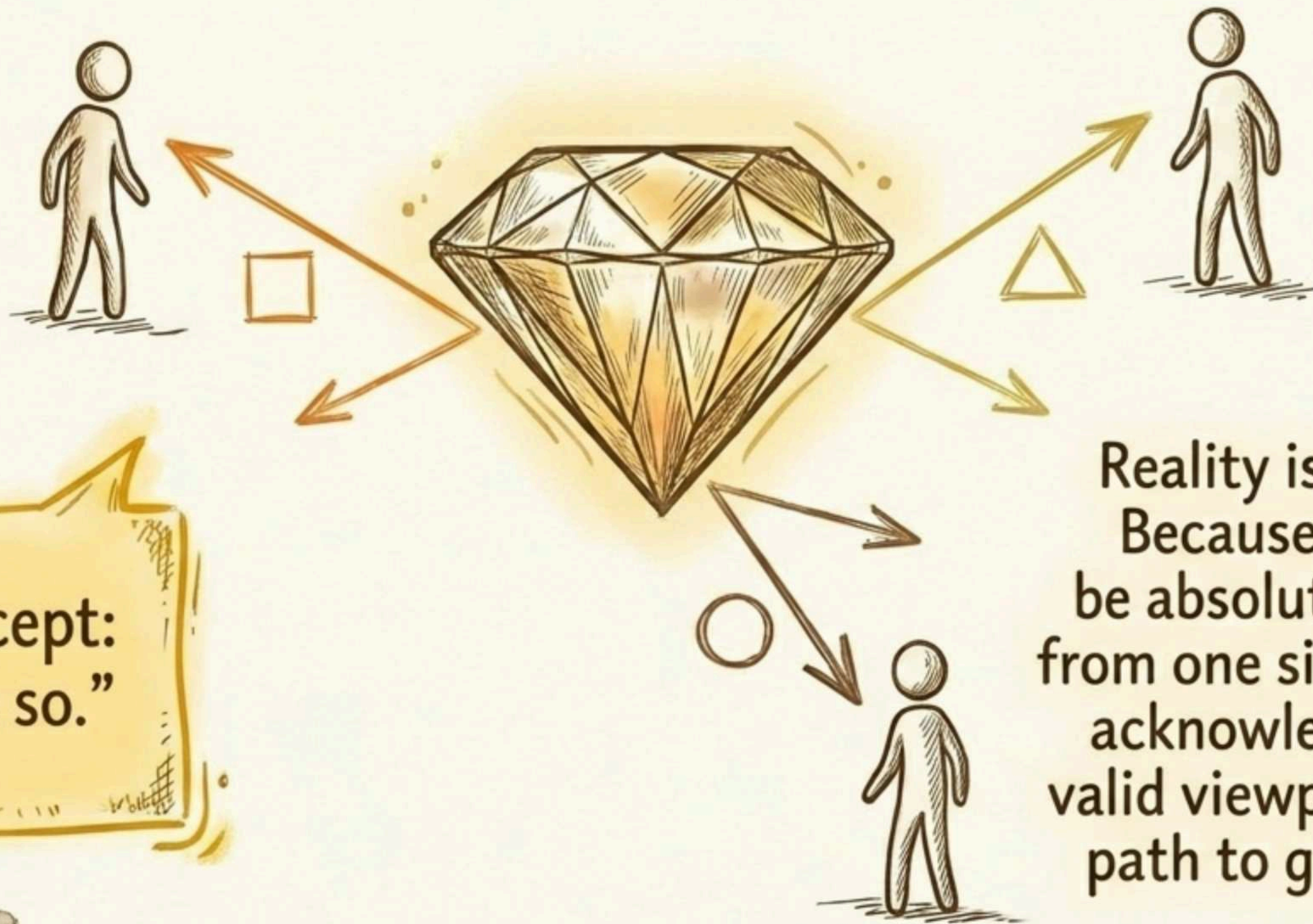
- Core View: Life is permeated by suffering (*duhkha*). Everything is impermanent (*anitya*). Inference is a valid tool for truth.
- Major Schools: Madhyamika, Yogachara, Sautrantika, Vaibhashika.



Jain

- Core View: Rejects "momentariness." Truth cannot be fully determined from a single angle.
- Code of Conduct: *Ahimsa*, *Satya*, *Asteya*, *Brahmacharya*, *Aparigraha*.

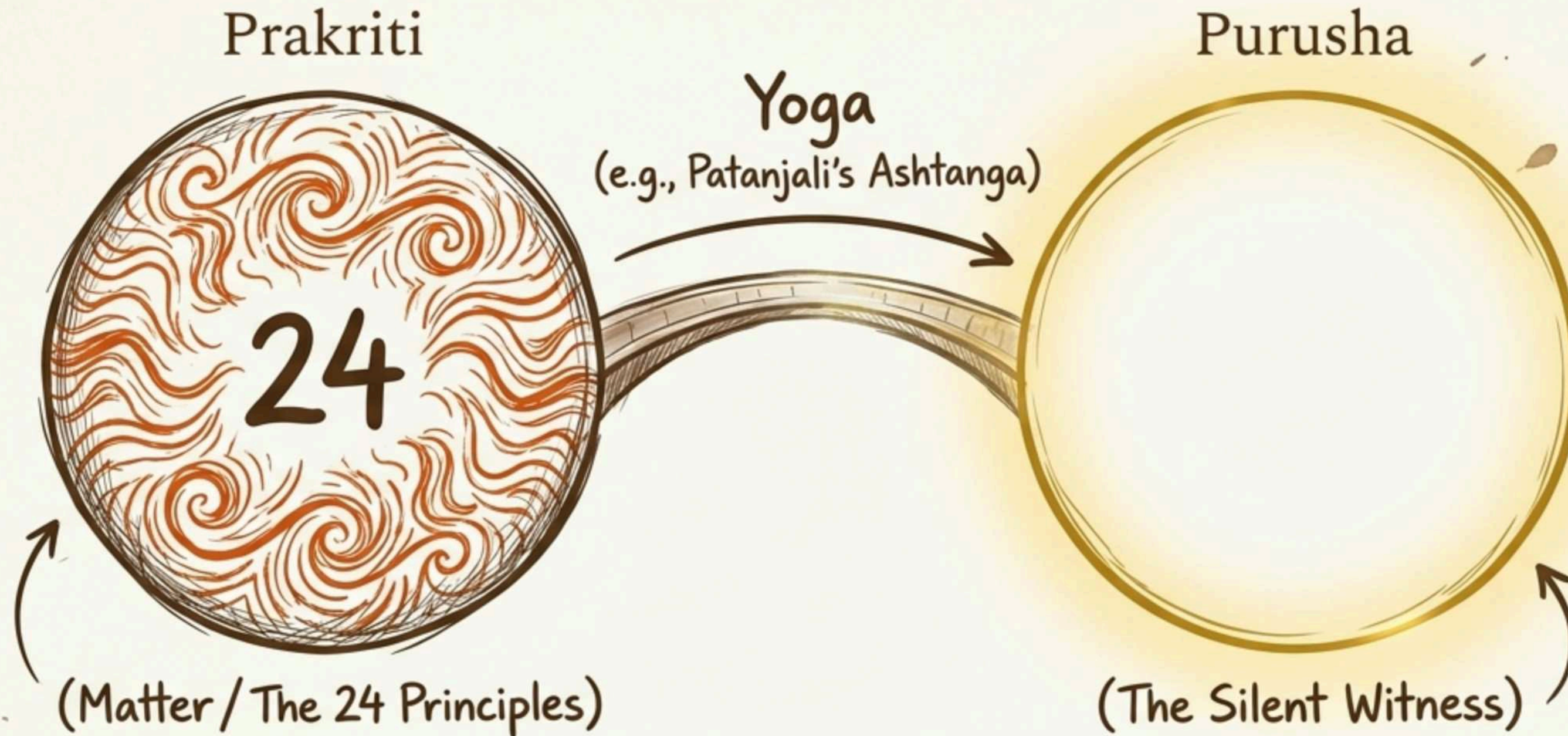
The Jain Doctrine of Syadvada



Core Concept:
"It may be so."

Reality is multifaceted.
Because truth cannot
be absolutely determined
from one single perspective,
acknowledging multiple
valid viewpoints is the only
path to grasping reality.

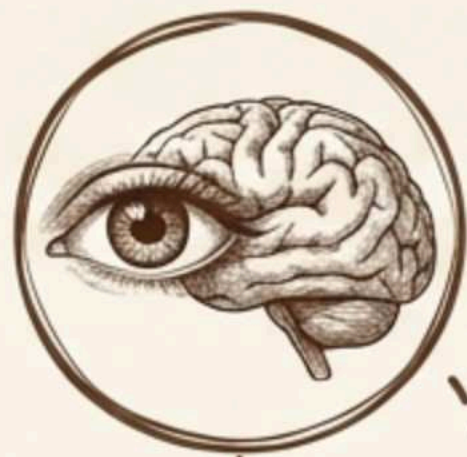
Samkhya & Yoga: The Anatomy of Suffering



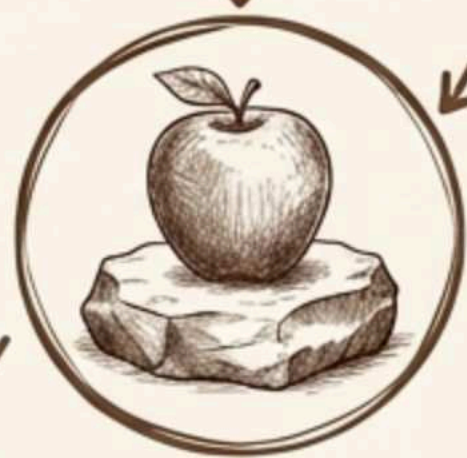
Concept: Suffering arises from confusing Purusha (true self) with Prakriti (matter/mind).

Action: Yoga is the direct practice and sadhana required to realize this separation and attain liberation.

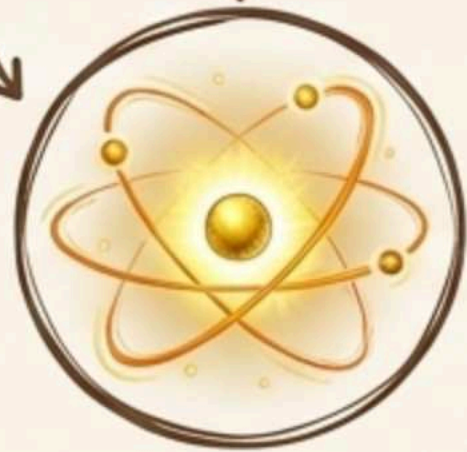
Nyaya & Vaisheshika: Logic and the Atom



Nyaya: Focus on *Pramana* (the lens, means of knowledge, and process of inference).



Vaisheshika: Focus on *Prameya* (the actual nature of the object).



Paramanu: The ultimate atom.

By systematically dividing objects into their component parts to find their distinguishing properties (*vishesha*), rational thought eventually infers the existence of fundamental atoms (*paramanu*).



Purva Mimamsa

- Based on the Vedas (Samhita and Brahmana mantra-vakyas).
- Focuses on karma yajnas and the testimony of those with direct experience when observation/inference fail.

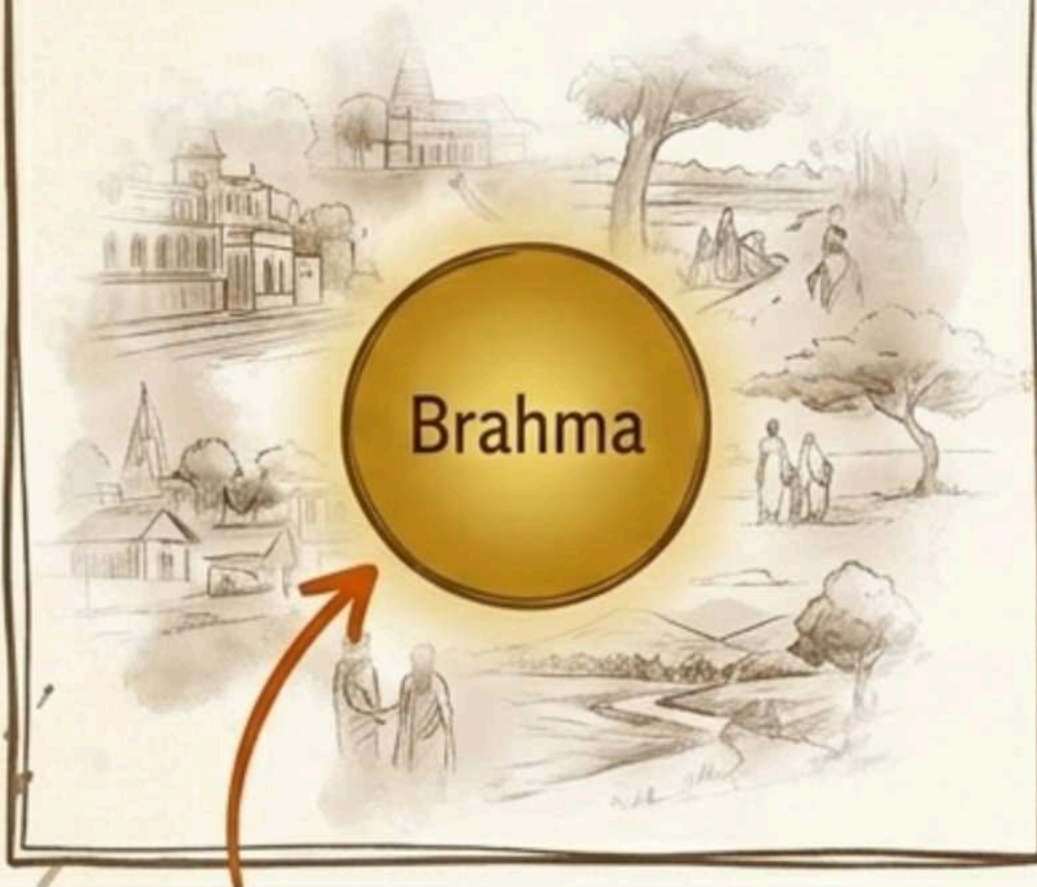


Uttara Mimamsa (Vedanta)

- Based on the Upanishads.
- Focuses on the testimony of the supreme state of experience.
- The most influential thought system in Indian life.

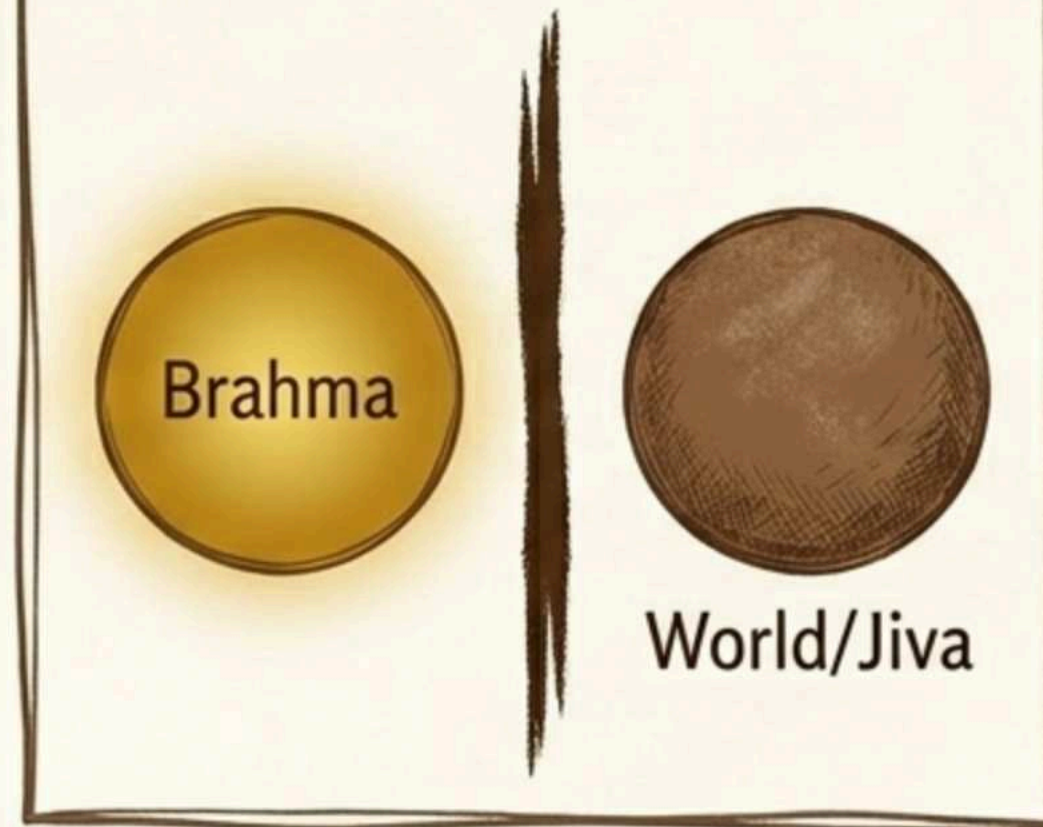
The Three Schools of Vedanta.

Advaita (Shankaracharya)



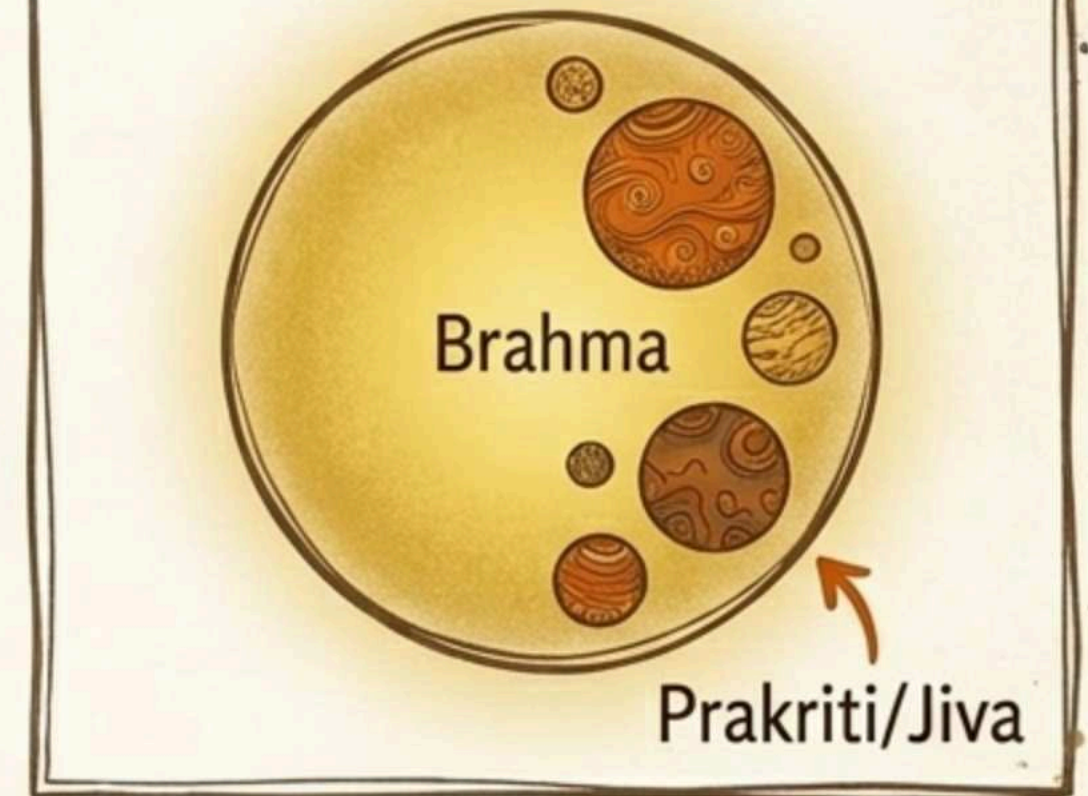
Advaita: The world is illusory; only Brahma (the Atman) is real.

Dvaita



Dvaita: Brahma is entirely distinct from the world and the individual soul (Jiva).

Vishishtadvaita



Vishishtadvaita: A balance. Prakriti and Jiva are attributes of Brahma, and Brahma is their controller.

Lokayata

Samkhya-Yoga

Nyaya-Vaisheshika

Buddhist

Moksha

(The End of Suffering)

Jain

Mimamsa-Vedanta

Though each system uses entirely different means—from logic and atoms to rituals and meditation—they all share the exact same ultimate aim: attaining peace, contentment, and joy.

All darshanas travel toward the single goal of moksha by different paths.

The Sarvadarshana-Samgraha

Context: Authored by Madhavacharya, this text compiles all major Indian philosophical systems together, from Charvaka to Vedanta.

The Marvel

Every system is presented using its own best arguments. No competing philosophy is ridiculed.

**A masterclass in ancient
Intellectual Tolerance.**



Which Path Are You On?



The Syadvada Challenge

"It may be so."

Think of a current family or social debate. Can you write down both sides with equal fairness? Are both partially true?

The Values Test

What is truly important in my life?

Charvaka says sensory joy. Buddhism says knowing impermanence. Vedanta says knowing the true self.

The Samkhya Check

What is my true nature?

Take a moment to ask: Are you your thoughts, or are you the silent witness observing them?